CONTRACTORLEADS.US: PRICING STRATEGY, UNIT ECONOMICS & COMPETITOR COMPARISON

Prepared for Leadership | Subject: Commercial Pricing, Waterfall Enrichment & Apollo Comparison | Date: November 2026 | Currency: USD ($)

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY: THE MARKET DISRUPTION STRATEGY

Most B2B lead platforms (Apollo, ZoomInfo, Hunter) ration credits aggressively to force users into costly upgrades. Because ContractorLeads.us operates a zero-cost proprietary scraper and internal database for standard leads, combined with an on-demand external waterfall engine, our baseline cost per lead is only 1.5 to 2.0 cents. This allows us to provide 3x to 4x more leads than competitors while maintaining 60% to 85% gross margins.

Two-Tier Consumption Architecture:

- **Tier 1: Standard Discovery & Search (1 Credit):** Company name, address, website, general office phone, Google rating, and review count. Resolved via our proprietary scraper and internal database at $0.00 in external API costs.
- **Tier 2: Optional On-Demand Deep Enrichment (+2 Credits):** Verified owner/founder name, job title, 100% SMTP-tested personal & work emails, direct mobile phone, and LinkedIn URL. Triggered strictly on-demand when the user clicks "Deep Enrich". Never run automatically. 0 extra credits charged if unresolvable.

2. DIRECT COMPETITOR COMPARISON

The table below compares ContractorLeads.us against market leaders across starter, growth, and agency price points:

PLATFORM	MONTHLY PLAN PRICE	LEADS / CREDITS INCLUDED	CUSTOMER COST PER LEAD	DECISION MAKER & MOBILE INCLUDED?	CONTRACTORLEADS VALUE ADVANTAGE
Apollo.io (Basic)	$49.00 / month	250 export credits	$0.196 (19.6 cents)	Mobile costs extra credits	Baseline benchmark
ContractorLeads (Starter)	**$39.00 / month**	**750 credits**	**$0.052 (5.2 cents)**	Included on-demand (+2 cr)	**3x more leads at 20% lower price**
Apollo.io (Pro)	$99.00 / month	1,000 export credits	$0.099 (9.9 cents)	Limited mobile reveals	Baseline benchmark
ContractorLeads (Growth)	**$79.00 / month**	**2,500 credits**	**$0.031 (3.1 cents)**	Included on-demand (+2 cr)	**2.5x more leads at 20% lower price**
Hunter.io (Starter)	$49.00 / month	500 email searches	$0.098 (9.8 cents)	No mobile phones or socials	Email only, no contractor CRM
Seamless.ai (Pro)	$147.00 / month	250 credits / month	$0.588 (58.8 cents)	Mobile search included	Expensive annual contracts
ContractorLeads (Agency)	**$149.00 / month**	**6,000 credits**	**$0.025 (2.5 cents)**	Included on-demand (+2 cr)	**Massive volume for outreach scale**
ZoomInfo	$12,000+ / year	Annual contract caps	$1.00 to $2.00	Yes	Requires sales calls & long lock-in

3. EXACT MASTER COST BREAKDOWN: EVERY API & SERVER EXPENSE

Every infrastructure component, third-party API, and server cost is detailed below. The last column displays the full all-in price per lead including the $17.00/month Railway server share (calculated at 2,500 leads/month baseline = $0.0070/lead):

SERVICE / PROVIDER	SYSTEM PIPELINE ROLE	PACKAGE / PLAN COST	DIRECT API UNIT COST	RAILWAY SHARE (2.5K)	FULL ALL-IN PRICE PER LEAD
Railway Hosting	Next.js Server & Database	$17.00 / month flat	Shared server base	$0.0070	**$0.0070 (0.70 cents)**
Internal DB & Scraper	Stages 1 & 2 (Checked 1st)	Included on server ($0)	$0.0000	+$0.0070	**$0.0070 (0.70 cents)**
Serper.dev (Google Search)	Stage 3 (Owner & Snippets)	$50 for 50,000 calls	$0.0010	+$0.0070	**$0.0080 (0.80 cents)**
NinjaPear (Nubela)	Stage 4.4 (Company & Execs)	$10 for 1,000 lookups	$0.0100	+$0.0070 +$0.001 Serper	**$0.0180 (1.80 cents)**
Apollo.io (Paid Plan)	Stage 4.1 (People Match)	$49 for 2,500 credits	$0.0196	+$0.0070 +$0.001 Serper	**$0.0276 (2.76 cents)**
Prospeo.io v2	Stage 4.2 (Verified Email & Phone)	$39 for 1,000 credits	$0.0300	+$0.0070 +$0.001 Serper	**$0.0380 (3.80 cents)**

SERVICE / PROVIDER	SYSTEM PIPELINE ROLE	PACKAGE / PLAN COST	DIRECT API UNIT COST	RAILWAY SHARE (2.5K)	FULL ALL-IN PRICE PER LEAD
Hunter.io	Stage 4.3 (Email Fallback)	$49 for 500 searches	$0.0350	+$0.0070 +$0.001 Serper	**$0.0430 (4.30 cents)**
ZeroBounce	7-Step SMTP Verification	$15 for 5,000 checks	$0.0030	Applied on external emails	**$0.0030 (0.30 cents)**
Hostinger Mail Relay	Warmup & Relay Dispatch	Included in domains ($0)	$0.0000	+$0.0000	**$0.0000 (0.00 cents)**

4. EXACT REAL DELIVERY COST BY CUSTOMER USAGE SCENARIO

Because users choose how to allocate their monthly credits (between standard search leads and optional deep enrichment), your real operational cost varies based on their usage mix:

CUSTOMER USAGE SCENARIO	CREDIT BURN RATE	APIS TRIGGERED	YOUR REAL COST PER LEAD	NET MARGIN ON STARTER ($39)
Case 1: Standard Discovery Only (User searches & exports regular leads)	1 credit per lead	Proprietary Scraper + Internal DB ($0.00)	**$0.0070 (0.7 cents)**	**86.5% Net Margin ($33.75 profit)**
Case 2: 70% Standard / 30% Deep Enrich (Typical user: exports list, enriches top prospects)	Blend: 1.6 credits per enriched contact	Internal DB + Google Serper + Prospeo / Apollo	**$0.0125 (1.25 cents)**	**76.0% Net Margin ($29.62 profit)**
Case 3: 100% Deep Waterfall Enrichment (Power user enriches every single lead with mobile/email)	2 credits per lead (375 enriched leads total)	Full Waterfall (Serper + Apollo/Prospeo + ZeroBounce)	**$0.0200 (2.0 cents)**	**61.5% Net Margin ($24.00 profit)**

5. SUBSCRIPTION TIER PROFIT MARGINS & REVENUE ECONOMICS

The table below analyzes total subscription revenue against worst-case delivery costs (assuming 100% of credits are redeemed by the user within the billing cycle):

SUBSCRIPTION PLAN	MONTHLY CUSTOMER PRICE	TOTAL CREDITS INCLUDED	DELIVERABLE CAPACITY	YOUR TOTAL DELIVERY COST	YOUR NET PROFIT	NET MARGIN (%)
Starter Plan	$39.00 / month	750 credits	750 standard OR 375 deep enriched	$5.25 to $15.00	**+$24.00 to +$33.75**	**61.5% to 86.5%**
Growth Plan	$79.00 / month	2,500 credits	2,500 standard OR 1,250 deep enriched	$17.50 to $50.00	**+$29.00 to +$61.50**	**36.7% to 77.8%**
Agency Plan	$149.00 / month	6,000 credits	6,000 standard OR 3,000 deep enriched	$42.00 to $120.00	**+$29.00 to +$107.00**	**19.5% to 71.8%**

Key Takeaway for Management:

In all realistic operational environments, users do not exhaust 100% of their credits on external APIs every month (breakage / unused credits average 25% to 35% in SaaS). Consequently, actual realized gross margins across your customer base will average **70% to 80%**, while providing customers with a market-leading lead volume that Apollo cannot match.

6. CORE OPERATING RULES CONFIGURED IN CODEBASE

- **1. Strict On-Demand Execution:** Regular search, map discovery, and viewing contacts run locally and never invoke paid third-party APIs. External APIs are queried only when the user explicitly clicks the "Deep Enrich (+2 cr)" action button.
- **2. No-Charge-On-Miss Guarantee:** If external APIs return no verified contact record, 0 extra credits are deducted from the customer's balance. This eliminates customer support disputes.
- **3. Dynamic Admin Control:** The optional enrichment fee (default: 2 credits) is fully editable at any time from Admin Console -> Plans & Pricing without code changes or server redeployments.
- **4. Automatic Direct SMTP Relay Failover:** Hostinger relay gateway on roofingclients.us is prioritized first, with seamless direct authenticated SMTP fallback ensuring 100% delivery for warmup and campaign verification.